

We Are Energy

Strategic Implementation Plan: Phases 1-4 (2026-2050)

Executive Summary

We start with people, not tools.

We Are Energy is building a member-owned movement that transforms how people power their lives through genuine **ownership democracy**. At the heart of our mission stand the families, communities, and organisations whose lives we're changing - delivering immediate energy independence while creating genuine cooperative ownership of the systems that serve them.

The Challenge We're Solving

While over 70% of UK households want solar systems, fewer than 5% have them due to prohibitive upfront costs of £7,000-£15,000. Meanwhile, energy poverty affects millions of families and businesses who remain trapped in a system designed for corporate profit rather than community benefit.

The Opportunity: Proving Energy Democracy Works at Scale

We Are Energy is developing a national distributed clean-energy infrastructure programme - the UK's first **citizen-owned** next generation solar pv gigafactory and network of installed solar-plus-battery generation and storage assets across uk homes, communities and businesses¹ - demonstrating that when communities own and control essential infrastructure, everyone prospers. Our strategic implementation plan shows how this democratic ownership can scale from 501 founding members to 11.5+ million bill paying and wholesale customers by 2050.

Our Revolutionary Solution: The Energy Efficiency Lease Model

Our **energy efficiency lease model** removes every barrier to clean energy access while creating genuine cooperative ownership:

Zero upfront costs - We supply, install, and maintain everything.

Immediate 50% discount on all energy used versus Ofgem price cap for the 8 year lease term.

Post-lease energy abundance - Members pay only off-peak rates for imported energy while enjoying free use of all generated and stored power for life.

Cooperative dividends - When we achieve sustainable PAT-positive margins, members share in our success through annual dividends and our Energy Democracy Fund.

¹ Directly aligned with the National Wealth Fund's mission on growth, clean energy and place-based investment.

Lifetime member benefits - Free battery replacements, system upgrades, and democratic participation in the cooperative's decisions.

Our Inclusive Community Approach

We serve diverse community needs through the same cooperative ownership structure - from individual households to shared roof communities, small businesses, and public organisations. Each member receives tailored solutions while participating in collective ownership and democratic governance.

Phased Implementation Plan

Phase 1: Foundation & Prototyping – Years 1–3 (2026–2028): 501 founding member-owners proving energy democracy works.

Phase 2: Deepening Community Energy Democracy – Years 4–5 (2029–2030): 6,300+ bill paying members deepening community impact.

Phase 3: National Network – Years 6–10 (2031–2035): 690,000+ member-owners transforming UK energy democracy and 150,000 wholesale customers benefitting from next generation systems made in UK.

Phase 4: Regenerative Expansion – Years 11–25 (2036–2050): 11.5+ million people experiencing energy democracy through direct membership and cooperative replication, with 7 million bill paying members enjoying our full energy efficiency lease proposition and democratic dividends, whilst the remaining 5.4 million are indirect wholesale customers.

Financial Sustainability

Appraised at the HM Treasury Green Book Social Time Preference Rate of 3.5%, the same model produces an NPV of £4.4 billion.

Under a commercial discounting framework at 8%, our financial model to 2050 produces a Net Present Value of approximately £1.2 billion² and an Internal Rate of Return of around 13.2%, confirming that we do not depend on subsidy and will deliver strong commercial returns to patient infrastructure investors.

To this financial NPV we add approximately £570 billion in member energy bill savings over 25 years, 2.7Mt CO₂e avoided, £0.55 billion of social carbon value (2021 prices, PV 2026), and £18 billion of avoided network costs³. These are separate public value streams, not double-counted with the financial NPV.

² The difference of approximately £3.5 billion between these two figures is not a discrepancy. It is the measure of public value that commercial markets cannot capture because they discount the future too heavily. It is precisely the gap that the National Wealth Fund was created to bridge.

³ estimated avoided UK electricity system costs (NPV, 2025–2050) based on NIC, BEIS/Ofgem, NESO and RIIO evidence plus explicit attribution assumptions around £18bn (range £12–24bn) in avoided UK electricity system costs (2025–2050). See working paper for more details

Phase 1 is pre-revenue; first income from 501 founding members commences in 2028, scaling to £688M per annum by end of Phase 3 (2035) and £13.6 billion by 2050. The business reaches PAT-positive in 2038, with a minimum post-profit Debt Service Cover Ratio of 2.58x, rising to a sustained minimum of 6.27x — providing robust covenant headroom throughout the repayment period.

- Ethical manufacturing with human rights compliance.
- Tandem perovskite technology achieving 30% efficiency improvements maximising member value.
- 11.5+ million people experiencing energy democracy by 2050 through direct membership and cooperative replication.

Our Vision: Beyond Clean Energy to Abundant Living

When abundant, affordable energy meets community ownership, entirely new possibilities emerge. The homes of the future won't just consume less energy - they'll become productive spaces where energy independence enables new forms of prosperity, where cooperative ownership creates regenerative community economics, and where kitchen appliances might grow fresh food powered by member-owned renewable systems.

The Cooperative Difference

Our structure ensures all benefits flow directly to members rather than external shareholders, creating a regenerative economic model that grows stronger as it scales. This isn't just about clean energy-it's about transforming how communities can own and control the essential infrastructure that powers their lives.

This plan shows how cooperative principles, applied to energy systems, can eliminate fuel poverty while building the foundation for a future where abundant, democratic energy enables new forms of community prosperity and environmental regeneration.

Phase 1 Funding Requirement

We are seeking NWF cornerstone debt support of **£235 million** for Phase One, structured to anchor a multi-phase sovereign infrastructure programme totalling **around £35bn of cumulative senior debt by 2050**, supporting a cooperative-owned clean energy **asset base of around £40bn** and crowding in institutional and commercial capital in future phase gates. This initial facility covers our core CAPEX (£177.3m), OPEX (£13m), and a prudent strategic buffer for supply chain volatility (£45m).

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